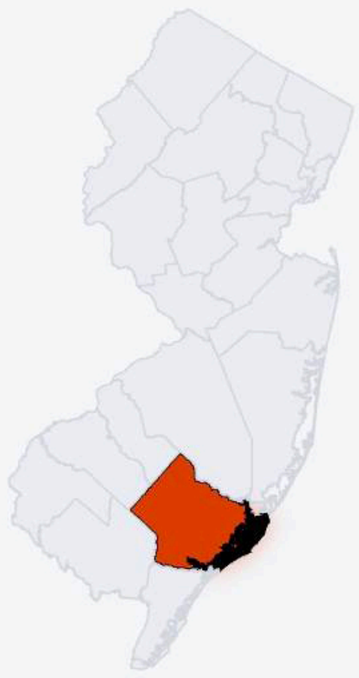
REBUILD BY DESIGN

NEW JERSEY CANNOT AFFORD TO WAIT

Atlantic County

Flood Risk, Population Impact & Public Infrastructure Exposure · 2025 → 2050 Projections



The Case for Dedicated Funding in Atlantic County

MORE PEOPLE AT RISK	ADDED TAX REVENUE AT RISK	MORE ASSETS EXPOSED
+24,690	+$63.4M	+45
additional residents by 2050	annual loss by 2050	additional by 2050

- **Atlantic County** has experienced **8 federal disaster declarations** since 2011, with **$51.0M** in FEMA obligations.
- By 2050, **106,992 residents** (39.0%) will live in flood-risk areas, with **24,690 more** residents exposed than today.
- **93% of NJ voters** want investments to reduce weather damage and **77%** are worried about extreme weather across party lines (FDU, 2024).
- NJ needs a dedicated resilient infrastructure funding source.

COUNTY OVERVIEW

FEMA DISASTERS	TOTAL FEMA (PA+HM)	POPULATION	SOCIAL VULNERABILITY	INFRASTRUCTURE
8	$51.0M	274,339	0.85	674
2011 – 2024	$186/capita	2024 US Census	Very High	13 types tracked

FLOOD RISK — PEOPLE & PROPERTY

PEOPLE IN FLOOD-RISK AREAS

2024	82,302
2050	106,992

PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE AT RISK

2025	262 (38.9%)
2050	307 (45.5%)

MARKET VALUE AT RISK

2024	$22.8B
2050	$26.5B

ANNUAL PROPERTY TAXES AT RISK

2024	$269.7M
2050	$333.1M

POPULATION DISPLACEMENT CATEGORIES

82,044 people in high flood risk areas

Of those, **67,129** (82%) are lower income and may not have the resources to relocate.

GROUP	PEOPLE	%
HIGH FLOOD RISK, LOWER INCOME	67,129	27.4%
HIGH FLOOD RISK, HIGHER INCOME	14,915	6.1%
LOW FLOOD RISK, LOWER INCOME	122,017	49.9%
LOW FLOOD RISK, HIGHER INCOME	38,375	15.7%

BLUE ACRES FINDINGS

20	31.8
COUNTY BUYOUT PARCELS	ACRES IN BLUE ACRES

Displacement is already underway, with **20 flood-damaged properties** already acquired through the Blue Acres program in Atlantic County, totaling **31.8 acres** and representing part of **1,677 statewide buyouts since 1987**.

PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE IN THE FLOODPLAINS

INFRASTRUCTURE TYPE	TOTAL	2025	2050	GROWTH
Parks	99	74.7% (74)	77.8% (77)	+4%
Wastewater Treatments	3	66.7% (2)	66.7% (2)	—
Contaminated Sites	284	45.1% (128)	52.8% (150)	+17%
Hospitals	18	27.8% (5)	44.4% (8)	+60%
Libraries	17	35.3% (6)	41.2% (7)	+17%
Power Plants	17	35.3% (6)	35.3% (6)	—
Fire Departments	58	27.6% (16)	34.5% (20)	+25%

INFRASTRUCTURE TYPE	TOTAL	2025	2050	GROWTH
Police Stations	23	26.1% (6)	30.4% (7)	+17%
Schools	99	17.2% (17)	25.3% (25)	+47%
Airports	5	20.0% (1)	20.0% (1)	—
Solid Waste Landfills	34	2.9% (1)	11.8% (4)	+300%
Hazardous Waste Sites	11	0.0% (0)	0.0% (0)	—
Superfund Sites	6	0.0% (0)	0.0% (0)	—

METHODOLOGY & NOTES

- This fact sheet draws from three Rebuild by Design research products: the **Atlas of Accountability** (county-level disaster declarations and federal spending, 2011–2024), **Flood Risk = Financial Risk** (parcel-level displacement and financial analysis of all 3.4 million NJ properties), and **Public Infrastructure Flood Risk** (exposure analysis of 18,959 public assets under 2025 and 2050 flood conditions).
- **Data Sources:** CDC/ATSDR 2022, EPA, FEMA, NJ Office of GIS, NJDEP, Rutgers University, Trust for Public Land, US EIA, USDOT.

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- For more information, contact info@rebuildbydesign.org